

## RESURRECTION: THE LIFE DEATH CANNOT DEFEAT

## Why a Dead Saviour Could Not Save Us

Christ rose bodily into incorruptible human life over which death has no dominion. He is the source, promise, and pattern of life for all who belong to Him.



## BIG IDEA

Jesus did not return to mortal life.  
He rose bodily into human life  
beyond death's dominion.

## KEY SCRIPTURE

1 Corinthians 15:20

ALSO READ

Romans 6:4-11

## MEMORY VERSE

ROMANS 6:9

"Knowing that Christ being  
raised from the dead dieth no  
more; death hath no more  
dominion over him."

## MAIN QUESTION

Why Is Christ's Resurrection  
Essential to Salvation?

45 MINUTES

## S

## SESSION SNAPSHOT



## SESSION GOALS

- Distinguish resurrection from survival and resuscitation.
- See that Christ rose bodily and will never die again.
- Understand Him as the firstfruits of a new humanity.
- Recognize that salvation depends upon a living Saviour.

## A

## OPENING ACTIVITY: "WHAT DOES ALIVE AGAIN MEAN?"

1

## WRITE THREE CLAIMS (2 MIN)

Write survival, resuscitation, and resurrection across the board. Ask students whether these words describe the same thing.

2

## DEFINE SURVIVAL (2 MIN)

The person continues after bodily death. This is real, but it is not yet resurrection because the body remains dead.

3

## DEFINE RESUSCITATION (2 MIN)

A mortal body returns to ordinary life and may die again, as Lazarus did. This moves backward into the old mortal condition.

4

## OPEN THE GOSPEL CLAIM (2 MIN)

Read Romans 6:9 and Revelation 1:17-18. Christ's body was raised and transformed. He moved forward into life death can never rule again.

## !

## LEADER GUARDRAIL

Do not reduce resurrection to proof that the cross worked, a symbol of hope, or the soul's survival. Christ truly died in His humanity and rose bodily. His risen human life remains created and dependent upon God; deathlessness is not divine aseity.

## +

## PREPARE

- Bible
- Board or paper
- Three colored markers
- Student handouts
- Review Sessions 4-6

A dead teacher leaves memories. The risen Christ gives life.

## Why a Dead Saviour Could Not Save Us

Christ rose bodily into incorruptible human life over which death has no dominion. He is the source, promise, and pattern of life for all who belong to Him.



## B CORE TEACHING

## 1 CHRIST TRULY DIED AND BODILY ROSE 1 Cor. 15:3-8

The gospel announces public events: Jesus died, was buried, rose the third day, and was seen alive. Resurrection is not a private feeling, moral recovery, or vision of a dead teacher.

EMPHASIZE: The same embodied Jesus who died was raised.

## 2 DEATH HAS NO MORE DOMINION Rom. 6:9

Jesus did not return to ordinary mortal life. He rose transformed and incorruptible, into created human life that remains dependent upon God yet can never die again.

EMPHASIZE: Resurrection moves forward, not backward.

## 3 CHRIST IS THE FIRSTFRUITS 1 Cor. 15:20-23

The firstfruits are the beginning and guarantee of the harvest. Christ begins the new humanity, and those who belong to Him will be raised at His coming.

EMPHASIZE: The promise belongs to those who are Christ's.

## 4 THE LIVING SAVIOUR GIVES LIFE Rev. 1:17-18

Salvation is not a benefit left behind by a dead hero. The risen Christ Himself is the believer's life, and His resurrection is the source, pattern, and promise of their bodily future.

EMPHASIZE: No resurrection means no life in Christ to share.

## ? DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

## 1 How is resurrection different from survival after death?

Follow-up: What happens to the body?

## 2 How is Christ's resurrection different from Lazarus?

Follow-up: Can death ever claim Jesus again?

## 3 Why does Paul call Christ the firstfruits?

Follow-up: What does the first part promise about the harvest?

## 4 Why could a dead Saviour not save us?

Follow-up: What life would there be for believers to share?

## 5 Who does Paul say will be raised in Christ?

Follow-up: How does verse 23 guard against automatic universalism?

## ! WEEKLY REFLECTION

Read 1 Corinthians 15:12-28. Follow Paul's 'if...then' argument.

- What would be true if Christ were not raised?
- What is true because Christ is risen?

## ! DO NOT CONFUSE THESE

**SURVIVAL** The person continues; the body remains dead.

**RESUSCITATION** Mortal bodily life returns and may die again.

**RESURRECTION** The body is raised and transformed beyond death.

## + PRIVATE CONVERSATION

Christian faith is trust in the living Christ, not agreement with facts about an absent hero. Invite questions and return the student to the risen Person.

## N LEADER NOTES

- Bodily, not symbolic.
- Transformed, not resuscitated.
- Created life, not aseity.
- Firstfruits, not universalism.
- Present union; future body.